



A special report
looking ahead
at good things
happening
locally
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Did you forget to set
your clocks
ahead
one hour
last night?
AP

**WORTH OF
MONEY-SAVING
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THE MORNING JOURNAL

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Lorain council rift exposed

Members' lack of communication, split on transparency cited

By **ALAN INGRAM**
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LORAIN — After 14 months of gathering nearly every Monday to conduct the city's business, some of the 11 members of Lorain City Council complain the body is divided. Others say communication is lacking.

Councilman Greg Holcomb, D-6, thinks City Council is divided in part because newer members of council want to operate with more transparency, while those on council longer prefer to do more behind the scenes.

"I think what you're seeing is exactly what the people asked for, (which) is they want to see a change in how our city government is run," he said. He thinks some members of council want to change things right away, and others are more inclined to run the city like they have been.

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Brother witnesses sibling get struck by oncoming train

By **CHANDA NEELY**
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LORAIN — A 53-year-old Lorain man was hit and killed yesterday when he tried to cross a set of railroad tracks in front of an oncoming train.

George Richard Smith was walking northbound on Broadway around 4:40 p.m. when he tried to cross the tracks near the Frank J. Nardini Gateway overpass. George's friend, Walter Lowe, made it safely across and William Smith, 55, George's brother, said he was walking behind George when he was hit by the train and he saw everything.

"I'm upset because I saw him get hit," screamed William Smith, as he cried with his brother's body lying just yards away under a cover.

George and William's younger brother was in shock when he arrived on scene to identify the body, saying "this is unbelievable."

George Smith was hit by Norfolk Southern Railway train No. 141, which travels from Bellevue to Buffalo, N.Y. The train was traveling eastbound and witnesses say the conductor sounded the horn to warn George Smith, but it was too late.

"I was (working) and all I heard was

See TRAIN, Page A4

ANALYSIS

Obama's recovery plans raising many questions

By **TOM RAUM**
Associated Press Writer

WASHINGTON — President Barack Obama offered his domestic-policy proposals as a "break from a troubled past." But the economic outlook now is more troubled than it was even in January, despite Obama's bold rhetoric and commitment of more trillions of dollars.

And while his personal popularity remains high, some economists and lawmakers are beginning to question whether Obama's agenda of increased government activism is helping, or hurting, by sowing uncertainty

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among businesses, investors and consumers that could prolong the recession.

Although the administration likes to say it "inherited" the recession and trillion-dollar deficits, the economic wreckage has worsened on Obama's still-young watch.

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KING 21 AND DONE



MORNING JOURNAL/DATE PARSONS
Admiral King's Vincent Lee is comforted by coach Albert Stacey, right, and an assistant coach following their 80-77 loss to Olmsted Falls yesterday at Midview High School in Grafton. For more, see Page C1.



Nancy Smith benefit dinner draws nearly 600

By **CHANDA NEELY**
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LORAIN — Nearly 600 people attended a benefit dinner at the Veterans of Foreign Wars Hall on Oberlin Avenue last night to raise money for dental work for former Headstart bus driver Nancy Smith.

"I was shocked (to see so many people)," Smith said. "I am really grateful. I want to thank them all for supporting me. I am so surprised at the outpouring of support I got."

The spaghetti dinner, which was \$12 for adults and \$5 for children ages 12 and younger, was organized by the Committee for Nancy Smith. The committee was formed by retired Judge Joseph Zieba, who said Smith, who has served 15 years in prison for sexually molesting four young children in 1991, was given "the shaft."

"I got a hold of all the transcripts," Zieba said. "I paid a couple of hundred dollars and I read them all and I saw what a horrible injustice was done to Nancy. I wrote a letter to the parole board for her last

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